

NEVER AN ADEYEMI

EPISODE 3: THE AGREEMENT

PALMFIRE SEASON 1

Screenplay draft

Based on Mario's final story brief and story bible

Contemporary Lagos romance with stakes

FADE IN:

INT. OBI FAMILY HOME - SITTING ROOM - MORNING

The photograph lies in a clear sleeve. Mr. Obi sits opposite Ify. The formal offer remains unopened.

IFY

You said Chief was a boy you knew.

MR. OBI

He was.

IFY

You left out the part where you grew up together.

MR. OBI

I left out many parts.

Mr. Obi opens a tin box and removes a browned agreement.

MR. OBI

This is the original partnership agreement.

IFY

Between your father and Chief's father?

MR. OBI

Equal partners.

IFY

Does it prove what they did to you?

MR. OBI

It proves the beginning. The ending is in papers I never saw.

IFY

You carried this all my life.

MR. OBI

I carried a paper. The rest I carried in my head.

IFY

You gave me a life built around silence.

He folds the agreement before she can touch the signature.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI OPERATING BUSINESS - ARCHIVE ROOM - DAY

Kunle opens a brittle deed folder. A clerk waits beside him.

KUNLE

This names Adeyemi Holdings as sole owner.

CLERK

The earlier ledger lists two partners.

KUNLE

Where is the original deed?

CLERK

This is the registered copy.

Kunle compares two signatures. The final ink drag is identical.

KUNLE

No.

CLERK

There is a note. File seventeen-B went to Mr. Afolabi's office.

KUNLE

When?

CLERK

Before the company moved.

KUNLE

And after?

CLERK

Nothing in the index.

Kunle closes the folder before the clerk can see the copied signature.

CUT TO:

INT. YEWANDE AND KUNLE'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

Yewande enlarges the photograph of the deed on Kunle's phone.

YEWANDE

This is not enough to prove forgery.

KUNLE

It is enough to make the codicil dangerous.

YEWANDE

Dangerous to whom?

KUNLE

To us.

YEWANDE

Mr. Obi has the agreement. He can tell a story, but he cannot finish it.

KUNLE

Then we need him to reject the offer.

YEWANDE

We need him to believe rejection is his safest choice.

KUNLE

And Ify?

YEWANDE

She is the door into the story.

KUNLE

She is not a handle.

YEWANDE

Then do not let her become a door.

CUT TO:

EXT. UNIVERSITY LAW FACULTY - COURTYARD - DAY

Ify sits with the photograph and her law books. Tobi brings two bottles of water.

TOBI

I brought the safe version.

IFY

Water?

TOBI

An apology.

IFY

You are becoming repetitive.

TOBI

I am practising.

IFY

Your family knows about the partnership.

TOBI

My brother found a deed. It may have been copied.

IFY

May have?

TOBI

I am trying to be careful.

IFY

Careful is how people keep a lie alive.

Tobi takes that without defending himself.

TOBI

I will find file seventeen-B.

IFY

Why?

TOBI

Because someone tried very hard to make it disappear.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - STUDY - AFTERNOON

Tobi confronts Kunle beside Chief's desk.

TOBI

Where is file seventeen-B?

KUNLE

You have been listening at doors.

TOBI

You have been emptying cabinets.

KUNLE

You do not know what you are accusing me of.

TOBI

I am asking where the file went.

KUNLE

When Mr. Obi signs, none of this matters.

TOBI

You keep saying that as if the signature will erase the past.

KUNLE

It will stop the past from taking the company.

TOBI

Maybe the company was taken first.

Kunle steps toward him. Tobi does not move.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI OPERATING BUSINESS - ARCHIVE ROOM - NIGHT

Tobi and Ify return with a flashlight. The cabinet door is open. The box marked 17-B is gone.

IFY

You said it was here.

TOBI

It was.

The records clerk appears at the doorway, frightened.

TOBI

Who signed the box out?

CLERK

I did not see anyone.

IFY

That is not an answer.

CLERK

It is the only one I can afford.

Tobi sees a fresh scrape on the cabinet lock and a torn index card on the floor: AFO-.

TOBI

Someone removed it tonight.

IFY

Then someone knows what is inside.

A phone vibrates in the dark corridor. Neither of them answers it.

FADE OUT.